through the incremental improvement that comes with experience, but if the player has a poor mental attitude he is often beyond help.

Cricket produces very few Mourinhos or Wengers, hugely influential coaches with minimal playing pedigree. The closest comparison I can come up with is Paul Farbrace, who worked as assistant to both Moores and Bayliss. A wicketkeeper-batsman with a modest career average of 18.23, he played only forty first-class matches, for Kent and Middlesex, over eight years.

Occasionally fallibility, or experience of marginal lack of fulfilment at the highest level, is an asset. Mark Ramprakash exemplifies the latter, Marcus Trescothick the former. He and Trotty have, through their individual trials and tribulations, done current and future generations a great service, by highlighting issues that too often remain unspoken.

The second phase of my captaincy was conducted under the toxic cloud we feared, because of the inability of the ECB to put the KP affair to bed. The campaign on Kevin's behalf was shrill, ceaseless and spiteful, but it was very efficient in highlighting the limitations of a governing body that lacked expertise in key areas.

I became frustrated with communications staff who failed to communicate and by edicts that left me in an impossible position. On one farcical Essex press day, every question to me was about KP but I wasn't allowed to answer. It was extraordinary that the situation had become so convoluted, and mired in legal complexity.

The ECB board couldn't deal with the power of social media. There was an inability to follow a consistent line of thought, impotence in the face of clever cyber-warfare, waged by proxy. Interested parties promoted the myth of KP's victimhood and turned the debate into one of perception of personality rather than principle. I felt like public enemy number one, and lacked conspicuous support from my employers. We weren't the first team Kevin had fallen out with, yet he was being portrayed as the good guy, a martyr to his art. The elephant had broken out of the room and was rampaging around the outfield at Lord's.

The situation was out of my control. I lost count of the conversations I had with the ECB, who didn't possess the quality of leadership the current CEO, Tom Harrison, provides. His predecessor, David Collier, who retired at the end of the 2014 season before taking up a role in rugby league, sat